about Kabul are empty, and the Juwans [young men] have gone (it is said) to aid the fight against us at Tezin.' Only on 2 November did Sale's brigade finally emerge from the pass into the plain and reach the small fertile village of Gandamak, near Shah Jahan's Nimla Gardens, where Shah Shuja's Contingent maintained a small barracks.

Here Sale and his officers paused to rest and recover for ten days – though, as the chaplain was quick to emphasise, it was a sober moment and 'nobody indulged to excess in the use of spirituous liquors'. It was here that what remained of Macnaghten's new Afghan regiment, the Janbaz, 'broke out in open mutiny and tried to kill the English officers . . . It was now evident that the whole country had risen against us, and it was not a mere rising of the Ghilzai chiefs to get their subsidies restored.'[78] The brigade had so far lost over 250 men in only a few days, and their position was clearly worsening fast. Rumours were beginning to arrive of heavy fighting in the passes behind them and around Kabul itself. So a Council of War was convened to decide the best course of action. Rather than keep going on to India, or return to Kabul, Sale and his officers decided to continue the remaining thirty-five miles downhill to Jalalabad, refortify the town and wait to see what happened next. Though no one was yet aware of it, this decision would change the course of the war.

Sale's brigade arrived in Jalalabad on 12 November and managed to seize the town without serious opposition. The low mud walls were crumbling and the troops found Jalalabad 'a dirty little town', but it was at least fertile and well watered on one side, by the Kabul River, which the hungry troops found to be full of delicious trout and the local *shir maheh* that they barbecued on charcoal. As Gleig commented, 'uninviting to the eyes of the ordinary traveller as this dilapidated city might have appeared, to the eyes of the brave but sorely harassed troops . . . it offered many and great attractions'.[79]

Broadfoot got to work rebuilding the fortifications on the afternoon of their arrival. Breaches in the curtain were filled, parapets and loopholes constructed, and ten artillery pieces were raised on to the bastions and prepared for firing. Foraging parties were sent out to gather food and fodder, and obstacles blocking the line of fire from the walls began to be demolished. The repairs were made just in time. The following morning a large mixed force of Ghilzai and Shinwari tribesmen appeared 'on the low